

some operators are able to upgrade their 3G core networks to EPC networks to support LTE, majority are installing new EPC networks. Operators' existing core networks are stretched to capacity by dramatic increases in mobile broadband data traffic and most view LTE deployment as an opportunity to install the latest core network technologies for improved network operations."

Security services spending growing

According to Gartner, worldwide security services spending is on pace to reach \$35.1 billion in 2011—up from \$31.1 billion in 2010. The market is forecast to total \$38.3 billion in 2012, and surpass \$49.1 billion in 2015.

"The security services market has changed rapidly over the last several years with a growing number of security technology providers offering their technologies as services, and customers often preferring services to save on operational costs while they consolidate resources to more strategic security related initiatives," said Lawrence Pin-gree, research director at Gartner.

India to have 121 million Internet users by year-end

India will have 121 million Internet users by December this year, states

a joint study by Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI) and IMRB. The increasing affordability of PCs and Internet penetration have been cited as the reasons behind this increase in the number of people using the Internet.

The report states that the number of Internet users in September this year was a hundred million and there will be an increase of 21 million users by the year-end. Also, it is possible for India to become the largest Internet using country in the world in this decade.

Solar sector to create 100,000 jobs

With India's plan to generate 20,000 MW of solar power under the National Solar Mission (NSM) for fueling its developing economy, the number of jobs in the sector are on a rise. It is estimated that the solar energy industry will need a workforce of 100,000 people by 2022 to achieve this milestone.

Many companies are taking interest in the Indian solar sector as the government is offering land for solar plants at lower rates. Funding too is easily available with foreign investment banks like Goldman Sachs, Blackrock and JP Morgan investing heavily in the sector.

EFY's electronics design community fan club grows multi-fold

EFY's Electronics Design Community Facebook page crossed the 130,000 mark on 29th October. The Fan Club since its launch in December 2010 continues to witness tremendous response, with over 400-500 electronics professionals joining the page every day.

"We realised that to build a successful forum for electronics engineers, we needed our platform to be where the engineers are. Facebook was a natural choice. We did expect to develop a rich community of electronics engineers but never expected an India-powered community to become the world's *numero uno* social media

community," shared Ramesh Chopra, founder and editor of *Electronics For You* magazine.

EFY's Facebook page caters exclusively to the electronics fraternity with discussions on the latest technology and trends, and knowledge sharing.

RIM sets up surveillance facility in Mumbai

Canadian handset-maker Research In Motion (RIM) has established a facility in Mumbai to help Indian government conduct surveillance checks on its BlackBerry services. Earlier this year, the handset maker had provided the Indian authorities with access to its BlackBerry messenger services to ease security concerns.

The facility, while handling lawful intercept requests for consumer services, will help RIM in decoding messages sent or received by a suspect as long as it is satisfied that the request has legal authorisation.

Mobile tariffs may go up

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) has said that it will stand up to its recommendation of over six-fold jump in 2G spectrum prices—a development which can increase the mobile tariffs across the nation.

The telecom regulator had earlier this year recommended Rs 109,725 million for the contracted 6.2MHz spectrum for pan-India licence as against Rs 16,580 million paid by operators till the last round of allocation of licence in 2008.

Each MHz of additional spectrum (beyond the 6.2MHz limit) held by operators would lead to one-time cost of Rs 45,719 million (all-India). It can vary from circle to circle and the operators would have to pay only where they hold extra spectrum. It is noteworthy that a majority of old licences are due for renewal in the next three to five years and operators would have to pay as per the current prices recommended by TRAI. This is bound to impose additional financial burden on the service providers,

